

Unit 10

Joining a library

Overview

Learners practise:

- understanding language relating to libraries
- joining a library and completing an application form
- saying numbers, months and years.

Suggested context

A library setting with a librarian and customer.

Dialogue 1: Asking about joining the library.

Dialogue 2: Giving personal details to complete a library membership form.

Skills

Speaking and listening

- Listen to dialogues about joining the library
- Listen for detail, e.g. address, postcode and telephone number
- Give information and ask for clarification
- Use clear pronunciation (including stress, rhythm and intonation) in saying numbers, months and years.

Literacy and phonics

- Read, say and write key words and numbers relating to a library application form
- Fill in a simple form.
- Organise graphemes into words

Language points

(Core points – bold, extension points – not bold)

- Simple phrases for:
 - **expressing needs/wants:** *Can I ...? Have you got ...? Can you help me, please? I'd like to... I want to...*
 - **asking for clarification:** *Sorry? I don't understand. Can you repeat, please?*
 - **giving personal information** (name, address, date of birth)
- **Key words and phrases:** address, phone numbers, dates (numbers, months, years), library signs
- **Vocabulary** such as *proof of identification (ID), address, a document, a bill, bank statement.*

Before you start

Depending on the level of your group, record the *Example dialogues* using local voices, accents and references. (See *Guidance* for further details.)

Print relevant images and word cards from this pack and the [New to ESOL picture pack](#). Source others which are relevant to your group, e.g. local library, application forms, etc.

TIP

Check learners' understanding of numbers 1 to 31 and months before doing these activities. Also, it is common for some people to use 1st January as part of their date of birth, if actual date of birth is not known or recorded.



Materials needed

Speaking and listening

Activity 1 Selection of realia (DVDs, CD, talking books, books and newspapers in a variety of languages etc.); **Resource 1: Images**; large envelopes.

Activity 2 **Dialogue 1**; **Resource 1: Images**; photo of local library; exemplars of documents to prove ID, e.g. bank statement, utility bill, benefits book, medical card.

Activity 3 **Dialogue 2**; **Resource 2: Worksheet**; **Resource 3: Application form**; other forms relevant for learners; 10 – 12 pre-prepared envelopes with names and addresses using local street names

Literacy and phonics

- **Resource 4: Word cards**; flashcards/strips of paper of other key words; telephone numbers to suit the group
- Copies of dialogue transcripts to make gap fill/ cut up words, etc.
- **Resource 5: Months** ([New to ESOL Time-saving templates](#), Template 9)
- Alphabet ([New to ESOL Time-saving templates](#), Template 8)
- *Look Say Cover Write Check* ([New to ESOL Time-saving templates](#), Template 3)

Note that each unit can be covered across two or three sessions. You can follow the order of activities suggested below or incorporate literacy, phonics, digital opportunities and resources/activities from other sources at different points across the sessions to best meet the needs, interests and priorities of your learners.

Allow some time at the beginning of each session for:

- General chatting
- A warm-up activity
- Recapping and reviewing the main learning from the last session and/or topic.
- Learners to tell each other about anything they have done or followed up related to the most recent topics.

Speaking and listening

Activity 1

Introduction to the topic

- As each learner arrives, greet them and give each person a piece of topic-related realia (ideally sourced from your local library), e.g. DVDs, books, newspapers (in English and learners' home languages, if possible), leaflets, CDs, audiobooks. Use **Resource 1: Images**, if helpful.
- When everyone has an item, ask each learner in turn: *What have you got? Can I borrow it?* Take it, thank them and continue until you have all the realia. Then give it back to them and thank them.
- Concept check 'borrow', then model and choral drill the question: *Can I borrow a book, please?* Drill again substituting 'book' with CD, DVD, newspaper, pen, etc.
- Place all the realia on the table in front of you. Prompt learners to come up and ask to borrow an item using the target language until all the items have been given out. As you hand the item to the learner, respond: Yes, of course. Here you are.

Intercultural understanding



This is a good opportunity to:

- flag up the services that libraries offer and that in many areas they are more like community centres, with many activities such as reading circles, baby/children's sessions, IT facilities, photocopying, café, etc. They are a good source of local information too.
- point out that it is free to join a library (but you have to join in order to use the facilities)
- explain that books, etc. can only be borrowed for a certain amount of time and that you pay a fine if you do not return them (or renew) by the stated date.

Activity 2

Speaking and listening (Dialogue 1)

- Show a picture of your local library and ask if anyone has been there. If so, ask some follow-up questions: *Why did you go there? What did you borrow? How do you join?* Lead a general discussion (if possible) about library services and mind-map key vocabulary on the board using **Resource 1: Images**. Discuss how to join a library and what documents you need to take with you, i.e. form of identification with name and address. Show an example bank statement and utility bill – elicit what they are and if learners have had to show these in other contexts.
- Before playing the audio clip, show **Resource 1: Images** – a customer service desk, a librarian and a young man who wishes to join the library (Ali). Ask learners to guess what the librarian and Ali are saying. Play **Dialogue 1** and check their guesses, e.g. *Can I help you? Can I join the library?*
- Set comprehension question: *What does Ali need to join the library?* Play the dialogue again and check the answer, i.e. a document with *proof of ID*, e.g. *bill, bank statement*.
- Re-check understanding of key terms and play the audio again, line by line. Choral drill focusing on pronunciation (including stress, linking and intonation).
- Practice: Learners role-play the dialogue in pairs, with a sample document to hand over when they say: *Here you are*. Write a few prompt words on the board for support, if needed.

Activity 3

Speaking and listening – numbers and telephone numbers

- Point at the date written on the board and ask: *What's the date today?* Point out that we say 'the 19th of April 2020', but we don't stress the underlined words or write them.
- Then say: *My birthday is (give date, e.g. 12th November.)* Ask a learner: *When's your birthday?* Wait for response then prompt learner to ask the next person. Continue around the group until everyone has asked and responded. N.B. Do not ask for actual dates of birth, i.e. with year.
- Elicit how you join a library, i.e. fill in an application form, and the kind of information it will ask for.
- Tell learners they are going to listen to the next part of the conversation. Ask: *What's does the librarian ask first?* Play the first part of **Dialogue 2** and check understanding of '*this*' in the first question, i.e. *the application form*.
- Set comprehension question: *How many other questions does the librarian ask?* Play the audio, more than once if necessary. Check the answer: 4 questions.
- Set comprehension question: *What are the 4 questions?* Play the audio, more than once if necessary. Ask learners to check in pairs, then feedback and write on board: (1) name & address, (2) postcode, (3) phone number, (4) date of birth.
- Hand out **Resource 2: Worksheet** and read it aloud. Ask learners to listen and select the correct information (put a tick or X) as they listen. Play the dialogue again and re-play as needed. Learners check in pairs, then feedback.
- Play the dialogue, line by line, choral drilling and focusing on pronunciation including stress, linking, intonation patterns in questions and answers, spelling out words and saying phone numbers.
- With a confident learner and **Resource 3: Application form**, model: *'Can you fill this in, please.'* *'No, sorry. Can you help me, please?'* Then ask learners to practise with other forms too.
- Drill the questions, one at a time: *What's your address/postcode/phone no./date of birth?*
- In pairs, learners practise the dialogue using either their own details or names and addresses from pre-prepared envelopes. They can use the transcript for support, if needed.
- Circulate and prompt learners to focus on clarification using the phrases: *Can you repeat that, please? Can you say that more slowly?*
- Sit with each learner individually, and repeat dialogue with learners using their own personal details.
- Role-play: Learners take turns to play the Librarian at the customer service desk while others ask questions.

Literacy and phonics

Reading

- Give pairs the transcript, cut into sections. Play the audio and ask learners to listen and sequence the transcript.
- Create gap fill activities from transcripts for learners to fill in (or copy/stick in). Remove key words such as *library*, *identification* and grammatical features such as *What's*, *this*, etc.
- Make flashcards of the library signs for reading practice. Or use **Resource 4: Word cards** for matching activities or Pelmanism.
- Learners can practise reading and copying important months for them to add to their word banks.
- Use choral, paired and independent reading techniques.

Phonics

- Use words with simple patterns to develop awareness of phoneme/grapheme relationship e.g. *help*, *got*, *this*, *proof*, *bank*, *bill*, *fill*, *that*, *with*
- Break words into syllables and say them slowly as you read them:
i – den – ti – fi – ca – tion, *li – bra – ry*.
Note that this changes the pronunciation.
- Put each grapheme on a sticky note for learners to put in the correct order, saying the sounds as they do so, e.g. *a – dd – r – e – ss*, *b – a – n – k*, *w – i – th*.

Writing

- Record additional versions of **Dialogue 2** with different details. Learners listen and complete a simple form (**Resource 3**).
- Complete **Resource 3: Application form** with own details.
- Copy information from leaflets/flyers/envelopes to complete simple forms
- Select words to learn to spell and write them on mini whiteboards.
- Use Months cards for practice in sequencing and copying.
- Choose key words for handwriting practice (including letter formation, etc.)

Numeracy

- Check learners' understanding of numbers 0 – 10. Hold up a number of fingers and ask: *How many?* Go through in sequence from 1–8, then randomly. Stop, then ask *How many?* without holding fingers up. Elicit: *zero*.
- **Telephone numbers:** prepare strips of paper with telephone numbers written in the format 01392 234 567. Prepare twice as many numbers as you have learners. Hold one up and read the numbers out slowly and clearly, using a natural rising and falling intonation pattern. Use natural spacing e.g. 07758 452 462.
- Learners take turns to pick up a strip and read out the number.
- In pairs, learners can use the strips to continue practising asking *What's your phone number?* and responding.

Digital opportunities



- Learners video/audio record their dialogues on their phones and listen to them afterwards to identify strengths and weaknesses.
- Learners can use their phones to take photos of items, record new vocabulary/phrases, use translation apps and practise their pronunciation.
- If possible, show a local library's website and point out the facilities on offer
- Learners go onto the local library website to find out opening hours, facilities, etc.
- Some learners may be able to create an information sheet about the local library using Word and images

Learning to learn

- Write new words in vocabulary book/personal word bank with images and/or translations.
- Learners save their own phone number, email, address and postcode in their phone contacts list.
- Spend some time drilling phrases to support understanding, e.g. *Sorry, I don't understand. Can you repeat that, please? Can you write it for me, please? Can you say it more slowly, please?* It can be helpful to back-chain when drilling to show where the emphasis lies.

Differentiation and extension ideas

- Learners can practise reading signs and forms, and filling in forms, using [New to ESOL resources https://esol.excellencegateway.org.uk/content/etf3061](https://esol.excellencegateway.org.uk/content/etf3061)
- To extend Activity 2, introduce alternative structures to express need: *I'd like to ... join the library/borrow a book/use a computer/use the toilet*. Encourage the use of social language and target language introduced in other sessions, e.g. *Excuse me, can you help me? Thanks for your help. See you later*.
- Extend Activity 3 to giving other personal details, e.g. email address and/or dates of birth (without years) of other family members.
- More confident learners can create their own dialogues in a different context, e.g. registering with a GP, dentist, children's club, nursery.
- Provide learners with leaflets from a local library about services and events, including free internet use. Learners take turns to ask and answer questions about opening times and internet access.
- Invite a librarian to come to the group with information about services (sessions for parents and children; other language support on offer; range of home language and dual language resources).
- At the next session, ask learners if they have joined the library. What did they find? What did they borrow? When is it due back?
- Recycle core language from this activity in future sessions (different contexts – joining a leisure centre/ children's club/doctor's surgery).

Out and about

- Show a flyer/poster/information sheet about a local library event, read together and discuss.
- Arrange a visit to a local library and help learners complete an application form to join. Afterwards, use the visit as the basis for creating a language experience text.

Home learning

- Ask learners to go to their local library, join if they haven't already, and borrow something to bring into the next session.
- Help learners to prepare their own questions to ask in the local library, e.g. *What time do you close? How many books can I borrow? Where are the toilets/café/computers? Do you have any books in Arabic?*
- Provide copies of **Resource 3: Application forms** for learners to take home for writing practice.
- Learners practise writing/spelling new words at home using 'Look, say, cover, write, check' method. See [New to ESOL Time-saving templates](#), Template 3.

Unit review



In your next lesson, and before you start a new topic, here are some ideas to help you review and recap language learning from this unit:

- ask learners to tell each other about their visit to a library
- play Pelmanism with key words and phrases
- review key vocabulary and phrases.

Useful links for further practice



- [New to ESOL Guidance document](https://esol.excellencegateway.org.uk/content/etf3083)
<https://esol.excellencegateway.org.uk/content/etf3083>
- [New to ESOL picture pack](https://esol.excellencegateway.org.uk/content/etf3064)
<https://esol.excellencegateway.org.uk/content/etf3064>
- [New to ESOL Phonics Pack](https://esol.excellencegateway.org.uk/learners-new-esol-phonics-pack)
<https://esol.excellencegateway.org.uk/learners-new-esol-phonics-pack>
- [New to ESOL time-saving templates](https://esol.excellencegateway.org.uk/content/etf3085), e.g. Template 2, sentence strips, Template 10 months
<https://esol.excellencegateway.org.uk/content/etf3085>
- [New to ESOL Topic 4 My time](https://esol.excellencegateway.org.uk/content/etf3122): Unit 2 My interests, Unit 4 My community
<https://esol.excellencegateway.org.uk/content/etf3122>
- English My Way: Accessing (local) services (you need to register)
<https://www.englishmyway.co.uk/topics/133>

Dialogue 1

Librarian	Hello. Can I help you?
Ali	Yes. Can I join the library, please?
Librarian	Have you got some proof of identification?
Ali	Sorry?
Librarian	A document with your name and address on it ... like a bill or bank statement?
Ali	Yes. Here you are.

Dialogue 2

Librarian	Can you fill this in, please?
Ali	No, sorry. Can you help me, please?
Librarian	What's your name and address?
Ali	Ali Massoud. That's A – l – i M – a – s s – o – u – d. 28D Franklin Road, Dover.
Librarian	And your postcode?
Ali	CT16 3BP
Librarian	What's your phone number?
Ali	07857 244 597
Librarian	And your date of birth?
Ali	21st February 1988



It's free to join. All you need to do is fill in this form and show us one proof of identity (ID). This should have your current address on. For example, you could show us a gas bill.

Section 1

Family name:

Title:

(Mr, Mrs, Miss etc)

Forenames:

Address:

Postcode:

Date of birth:

Telephone:

Email address:

Section 2 (For people under 18) Please
part. They must be over 18. Your guara

fill in this

Staff use only

Borrower number

Borrower type:





*Welcome
to the
library*

**Library
closed
today**



Choose the correct answer

Name	Ali Massoud	Abdi Massoud
Address	28B Franklin Road, Dover	28D Franklin Road, Dover
Postcode	CT16 3PB	CT16 3BP
Phone number	07857 244 597	07847 244 597
Date of birth	21st February 1978	21st February 1988

Choose the correct answer

Name	Ali Massoud	Abdi Massoud
Address	28B Franklin Road, Dover	28D Franklin Road, Dover
Postcode	CT16 3PB	CT16 3BP
Phone number	07857 244 597	07847 244 597
Date of birth	21st February 1978	21st February 1988

Name	
Address	
Postcode	
Phone number	
Date of birth	
Email	

To join a library, you need to show proof of identification (name and address) such as:

- driving licence
- bank statement
- building society book
- Post Office savings book
- welfare benefits book
- pension book
- bus pass
- receipted bills
- council tax demand
- medical card

(information adapted from <https://derbyshire.gov.uk/leisure/libraries/using-your-library/joining/joining-the-library.aspx>)

Toilets	Computers
DVDs	Help desk
Children's books	Self-service point
Open	Closed

January

February

March

April

May

June

July

August

September

October

November

December